

OnePlus Nord 6

The mid-range masquerade is over

If the Nord 5 was OnePlus putting its foot down, the Nord 6 is the company kicking the door wide open. The OnePlus Nord 6 with the Snapdragon 8s Gen 4, a colossal 9,000 mAh battery, a 165Hz display and durability credentials that rival rugged phones, is no longer a mid-range phone pretending to be something more. It is something more. Starting in the Rs 35,000–45,000 segment, the Nord 6 feels like OnePlus declaring war on any price bracket that tries to contain it. But does the experience match the claims? Let's find out.

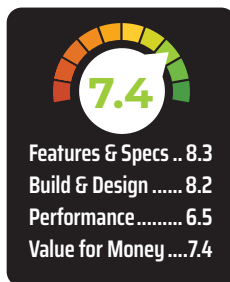
BUILD AND DESIGN

The Nord 6 takes the design aesthetics of the Nord 5 and pushes it into flagship territory. Where the Nord 5 traded the Nord 4's metal design for a sleeker silhouette, the Nord 6 draws clear inspiration from OnePlus' own number series.

At 8.5mm thick and 217g, the Nord 6 is marginally thicker than the Nord 5's 8.1mm profile, but that's entirely justified by the enormous 9,000 mAh battery it houses. The frame and the rear panel is crafted out of plastic while the camera deco housing is made from aluminum. The weight distribution remains well-balanced and the phone sits comfortably in hand without feeling unwieldy.

There are three colour options: Fresh Mint, Quick Silver and Pitch Black. I've been using the Fresh Mint colour which looks vibrant without being loud. The Quick Silver has a metallic sheen with two lines running along the periphery, while Pitch Black is understated, clean and fingerprint-friendly.

₹38,999



The Plus Key returns on the left side, continuing its role as a dedicated Mind Space AI shortcut. It's still not the beloved alert slider of old, but the utility it offers including quick access to Mind Space, AI Search and Gemini makes it more than a worthy replacement, especially as OxygenOS 16's AI features grow more capable.

In terms of durability, the Nord 6 carries IP66, IP68, IP69 and IP69K ratings. That's protection against dust, water immersion and even high-pressure, high-temperature water jets. OnePlus has also thrown in MIL-STD-810H military-grade certification and Crystal Guard display protection (which OnePlus claims is on par with Corning Gorilla Glass Victus Plus). There's also a Sandstone Magnetic Case (bought separately) for those who want OnePlus'

iconic tactile finish with magnetic accessory compatibility, including the optional 27W Ice-Cooled Magnetic Back Clip for extended gaming sessions.

PERFORMANCE & SOFTWARE

The Nord 6 takes another meaningful leap in raw performance, powered by the Qualcomm Snapdragon 8s Gen 4 and OnePlus has paired it with LPDDR5X RAM (8GB or 12GB) and UFS 4.1 storage (256GB only, no 512GB option), creating a hardware package that punches well above its price.

The 85% CPU throttling score indicates the Nord 6 maintains excellent sustained performance, edging out the Nord 5's 84% and suggesting OnePlus' massive 33,147 mm² heat dissipation area is doing serious work behind the scenes.

In daily use, the Nord 6 is blisteringly fast. App launches are instantaneous, multitasking between heavy apps like Google Maps, Instagram, Chrome and the camera is seamless and the UFS 4.1 storage (a jump from the Nord 5's UFS 3.1) makes file transfers and app installs noticeably snappier.

GAMING PERFORMANCE

The Nord 6 is the segment's first phone to deliver steady 165 FPS gameplay on AAA titles and our testing confirms the claim holds up:

The near-perfect smoothness scores across titles like BGMI and COD Mobile mean you're getting a visually fluid, stutter-free experience that genuinely rivals flagship gaming phones. OnePlus also supports 165 FPS in Free Fire, Free Fire MAX, Mobile Legends: Bang Bang, Brawl Stars, Clash of Clans and Clash Royale, among others.

The gaming experience is further enhanced by the dedicated 6-axis gyroscope (±4,000 DPS) for precision aiming, a Spatial Audio Booster for directional cues and the aforementioned optional 27W Ice-Cooled Mag-